

# The Boston Globe

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‘There has to be the political will on the city’s part to really make it a reality.’

MINIARD CULPEPPER, *Boston city councilor*

## Delays aren’t only hurdle for reparations panel

By Mara Kardas-Nelson  
GLOBE STAFF

When Boston passed an ordinance in 2022 to make suggestions for reparations for Black Bostonians, the city set an ambitious deadline: It would release research by the end of 2023 documenting Boston’s role in the trans-Atlantic slave trade and the continued impacts of slavery and discrimination. The research would be a key first step to inform the city’s recommendations for reparations.

It’s missed that deadline by a wide margin, and only now, more than two years later, is the city’s Equity and Inclusion Cabinet, which oversees Boston’s Task Force on Reparations, on the cusp of having those reports in hand. Still, though, they are not expected to be made public for several more months.

One report, written by outside experts at Northeastern University and detailing discrimination against Black Bostonians

REPARATIONS, Page A7

## Emails show how ballot question on tax fell apart

Exchange on wording of summary detailed

By Chris Van Buskirk  
GLOBE STAFF

In emails last August, a top lawyer in Attorney General Andrea Campbell’s office traded proposed wording for a summary of a ballot question to cut Massachusetts’ state income tax with an attorney representing the authors of the proposal.

At Assistant Attorney General Grace Gohlke’s invitation, Kevin Martin, a Goodwin Procter attorney, suggested language that did not mention an indirect but critical out-

come of the ballot question: that it would also slash the tax rate on long-term capital gains.

Required by the state Constitution, the summary is a critical component of the ballot process in Massachusetts. It is supposed to represent a fair and concise summation of the initiative and not improperly tip voters in one direction or the other.

But in the back and forth, Gohlke and Martin settled on wording that, likely unbeknownst to them, spelled the end of the tax cut proposal.

At one point, Gohlke suggested language saying the proposal would “not” change the capital gains tax rate. Martin countered by suggesting only using “positive descriptions.”

Then in one critical exchange, Gohlke suggested it was “important to explain” how a large tax category that includes wages and salaries is defined as “excluding” long-term capital gains income.

“Hi Grace,” Martin responded the next day, Aug. 21, 2025, giving a thumbs up. “That summary works well for proponents, thanks so

BALLOT QUESTION, Page A7

## PITCH FEVER

Friday was a beautiful day for the beautiful game. Clockwise from left: Cam Arnold, Mark Graham, and Alejandro Juste celebrated on Boston Common after the US beat Australia, 2-0, to advance to the knockout stage of the World Cup. Tarik Elasri, rooting for Morocco, motioned for a call while watching the match against Scotland on the Common. Members of the Tartan Army sang and cheered on a school bus en route to the game in Foxborough, where Scotland lost to Morocco, 1-0. **B1, C1.**



CLOCKWISE FROM LEFT: CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE; CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE; JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

## US immigration restrictions shut out fans from certain countries

By Giulia McDonnell  
Nieto del Rio  
GLOBE STAFF

Even as international soccer fervor has transformed Boston over the past few weeks, thousands of fans from countries facing rigorous immigration restrictions have been forced to miss the action or endure headaches in getting to the US.

Those from many African, Carib-

bean, Middle Eastern, and Latin American countries, including those with large diasporas in Massachusetts, such as Cape Verde and Brazil, face enhanced vetting and long wait times as they attempt to travel here. In some cases, they are required to pay up to \$15,000 in bond funds to obtain a visa. And Haitian nationals are entirely barred from acquiring a tourist visa, with few exceptions.

Meanwhile, visitors from a variety of countries including Norway and Scotland fall under the US Visa Waiver program, which allows them easier entry into the US.

For Joanne Mondestil, who is Haitian and lives in Boston, the disappointment was palpable, even with all the excitement of cheering on Haiti in Boston in its first World Cup appearance since 1974 last

week. She would have liked for people to be able to travel here for the festivities.

“The reality is that a lot of us didn’t get to celebrate as we had hoped, with all of our brothers and sisters,” said Mondestil.

The administration has loosened some rules for World Cup ticket holders, including waiving visa bond requirements and expediting visa

appointments through its FIFA Pass system, but that only works for those who have game tickets before entering the country.

“The party that we see on TV doesn’t reflect the hardships that a lot of people from these countries are having with getting visas to enter,” said Jesse Bless, an immigration attorney in Boston.

VISAS, Page A6

### A DANCER’S POSE



Light, bright

**Saturday:** Partly sunny.  
High: 77-82. Low: 60-65.  
**Sunday:** Getting brighter.  
High: 77-82. Low: 61-66.  
Sunrise: 5:07 Sunset: 8:24  
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**  
Obituaries, **C10.**

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CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Ellice Patterson performed as the Firebird in Abilities Dance Boston’s presentation of “Firebird, Part 2” being performed Juneteenth weekend at Boston University’s Joan & Edgar Booth Theatre. Patterson is the executive and artistic director of the studio. **B1.**

Phil Eng, the state’s top transportation official, acknowledged that his actions nearly two years ago were “insensitive” when he pulled the hair of one of his employees after a MBTA team dinner. **B1.**

Roughly 130 servers, cooks, cashiers, and other workers at Logan International Airport unanimously voted to authorize a strike as they demand better wages and affordable health insurance. **D1.**

## Kennedy Center name is back but questions linger

After Trump interventions, a murky future

By Julian E.J. Sorapur  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — There were cheers at the Kennedy Center a week ago, but the audience wasn’t lauding some revelatory work of art. Rather they encouraged a more unorthodox spectacle: construction workers up on 60-foot scaffolding removing President Trump’s name from the face of the building by order of a federal judge.

Despite the letters being pried from the building, a larger question remains: What’s next for the nation’s premier

performing arts center?

After all, the president has sought to close the Kennedy Center for two years amid a massive renovation. For now, its performance calendar is sparse beyond July 3, consisting mostly of outdoor movie screenings.

The federal judge who ordered the removal of Trump’s name, Christopher Cooper, has also blocked the closure. On Tuesday, he ruled the Kennedy Center board must present a plan to the court for staying open by Friday. (As of Friday evening, the board had yet to file.)

Change has been the norm since February 2025, when Trump fired every member of the center’s board of trustees

KENNEDY CENTER, Page A4

